Tampereen yliopisto
Tampere University

FYS.330 Project Work

Project plan

PROJECT TITLE GOES HERE

First Author, Second Author, Third Author

September, 2026

CONTENTS

1 Background, aim and objectives 3
1.1 Significance of the project 3
1.2 Research questions and/or goals 4
1.3 Expected results and their potential impact 4
2 Implementation 5
2.1 Work plan and schedule 5
2.1.1 Turning calendar weeks into a clean chart 5
2.2 Data and material, methods, and working environment 6
2.3 Risk assessment 7
3 Team and collaborators 8
3.1 Project personnel 8
3.2 Collaborators 8
4 Budget 9

1 BACKGROUND, AIM AND OBJECTIVES

1.1 Significance of the project

> ***Template instructions:*** *Explain, for a reader outside your group, why this project is worth doing. Set the scene: what is the broader scientific, technical or societal context? What existing gap, problem or open question motivates your work? Aim for roughly half a page to one page. Delete this box and replace the placeholder text below with your own content.*

Describe the wider context and motivation for the project here. What field does the project belong to, what is currently known, and why does it matter? Keep this section understandable to a reader who is not a specialist in the topic.

1.2 Research questions and/or goals

> ***Template instructions:*** *State the concrete questions your project sets out to answer, or the concrete goals it aims to reach. Bullet points work well here. Each question/-goal should be specific enough that you can later judge, objectively, whether it was answered or reached. Avoid vague goals such as "learn more about X" – prefer "determine how X affects Y under conditions Z".*

The main goal of this project is to ***[state the overall aim in one sentence]***. Our specific research questions are:

- ***[Research question 1]***
- ***[Research question 2]***
- ***[Research question 3]***

1.3 Expected results and their potential impact

> ***Template instructions:*** *Describe what you expect to find out or produce, and who would benefit from it (your field, future students, an external collaborator, society more broadly). This section should connect back to the significance described above – i.e. explain how reaching your goals addresses the motivation you gave earlier.*

Describe the expected outcomes of the project and their relevance here.

2 IMPLEMENTATION

2.1 Work plan and schedule

> ***Template instructions:*** *Describe, in a short paragraph, how the project is organised in time: which phases exist, which ones depend on each other, how the team is split into sub-groups (if any), and how progress will be tracked (e.g. weekly meetings, a project manager). Then present your schedule using a* **Gantt chart** *(Table 2.1) that visualises the data week by week. Keep the Gantt chart in this exact format (same task IDs, same column order) matters beyond good looks: because the data lives in a plain, predictably-structured LaTeX table rather than an image, it can later be parsed automatically to regenerate task lists (e.g. for an issue tracker or a status-meeting agenda) instead of retyping them by hand.*

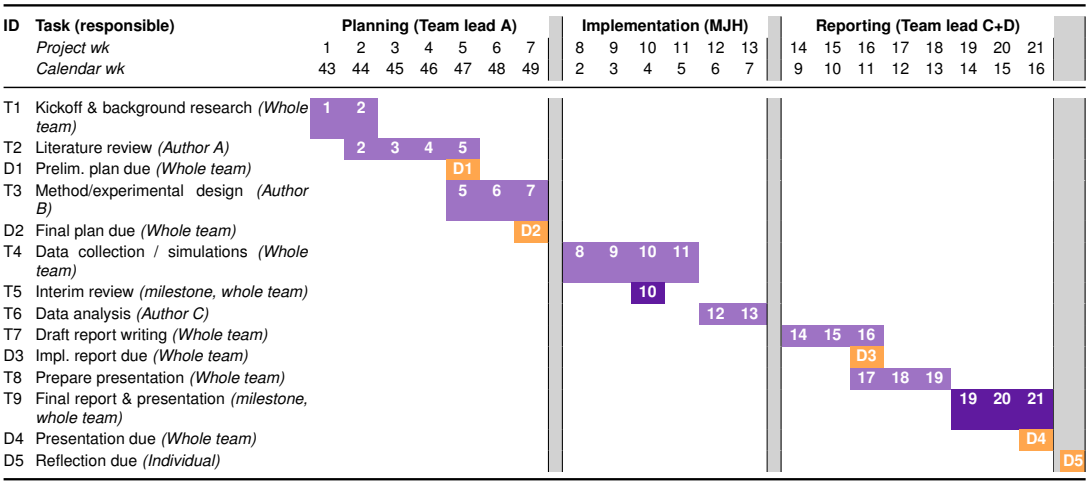
The project is divided into three phases (Planning, Implementation and reporting) and team-specific tasks, with a visual overview of the schedule given in Table 2.1.

> ***Template instructions:*** *The Gantt chart below covers the whole 21-week course timeline (see Section 2.1.1), with each column carrying two stacked labels – the sequential* **Project week** *on top and the real ISO* **Calendar week** *below – so the chart is both clean to scan and traceable back to actual dates. Four narrow grey columns mark the non-working weeks, all deliberately excluded from the Project week count: the Christmas break (calendar weeks 50–52/2026 and week 1/2027) between Planning and Implementation, the spring exam week (calendar week 8/2027) between Implementation and Reporting, and a two-week exam period (calendar weeks 17–18/2027) after Reporting, at the very end of the chart. Each shaded task cell shows its own project-week number in* `\tiny` *type (*`\gwk{n}` *for a normal active week,* `\gwkm{n}` *for a milestone week); the responsible person/sub-team is named after each task. Deliverables are also shown with* `\gdl{Dn}` *(an orange marker, to stand apart from task/milestone cells). Note D5 sits inside the trailing exam-break column since its deadline falls in that week even though no project work is scheduled then. Vertical rules mark the three project phases.*

2.1.1 Turning calendar weeks into a clean chart

1. **Number project weeks sequentially, not by calendar week.** Keep a small lookup table (Table **??**) that maps each sequential ***Project week*** to its real ISO calendar week and dates, and use only the sequential number in the Gantt chart itself.
2. **Exclude non-working weeks from the numbering**, marking them explicitly in the

Table 2.1. *Example Gantt chart built across the full 21-week course timeline, one row per task/deliverable (with its responsible person initials/team), interleaved in chronological order, one column per project week, each labelled with both its project week and its real calendar week. The four narrow grey columns mark, in order, the Christmas break, the spring exam week, and the two week end-of-term exam period. Vertical rules mark the boundaries between the Planning, Implementation and Reporting phases. Mark team leaders into the phase labels (e.g. Planning (Mikko+Panu), so that an assigned main responsible person can be always found. If space becomes tight, you may use person's initials, e.g. MJH, and clarify the used notation in the table caption.*



lookup table (e.g. "Christmas break") instead of giving them a numbered column in the chart – though, as Table 2.1 shows, a narrow shaded column can still mark *where* the break falls without breaking the numbering.

3. **If the remaining working-week count is still large, aggregate.** Either (a) let each Gantt column represent two calendar weeks (halving the column count), or (b) split the chart into two linked tables at the natural term boundary (e.g. one for the autumn instalment, one for the spring instalment), each formatted exactly like Table 2.1 and using the same task IDs.

2.2 Data and material, methods, and working environment

Template instructions: *Describe what data or material you will work with, how you will obtain it (measurements, simulations, existing data sets, literature values), which methods/software/equipment you will use, and where the work will physically or computationally take place (which lab, which cluster, which facility). Bullet-point lists of the specific cases/conditions you will study or measure are encouraged, as in the example below.*

Describe your data sources, methods and working environment here, for example:

- ***[Condition / case 1 to be studied or measured]***
- ***[Condition / case 2 to be studied or measured]***
- ***[Condition / case 3 to be studied or measured]***

2.3 Risk assessment

Template instructions: *Identify the main risks to the project succeeding on schedule: e.g. unfamiliar topic/methods, equipment or collaborator availability, team dynamics, or external dependencies. For each risk, briefly state how you plan to reduce or manage it. This does not need to be exhaustive – focus on the two or three risks most likely to actually affect your timeline.*

- ***[Risk 1]*** – ***[mitigation plan]***
- ***[Risk 2]*** – ***[mitigation plan]***
- ***[Risk 3]*** – ***[mitigation plan]***

3 TEAM AND COLLABORATORS

3.1 Project personnel

> ***Template instructions:*** *List every team member with one short paragraph each: their year/programme, their role in the project (e.g. project manager, simulation lead, measurement team), and the relevant background or skills they bring.*

[Full Name]
Xnth year student, ***[role in the project]***
[One or two sentences on relevant background, skills or responsibilities.]

[Full Name]
Xnth year student, ***[role in the project]***
[One or two sentences on relevant background, skills or responsibilities.]

3.2 Collaborators

> ***Template instructions:*** *List any external people, research groups, companies or facilities the project collaborates with, and briefly state what each collaborator contributes (equipment, expertise, data, funding, etc.). Remove this section if the project has no external collaborators.*

We are collaborating with ***[collaborator/institution name]***, which provides ***[what they contribute – equipment, expertise, data, etc.]***.

4 BUDGET

Template instructions: *List the expected costs of the project: materials, consumables, equipment or software (including licenses), travel, and any other significant expense. A short table (item, quantity, estimated cost) works well if you have several items; a paragraph is enough if the budget is simple or still uncertain. If costs are not yet known at the time of writing, say so explicitly and state when/how the estimate will be finalised (e.g. after a meeting with a collaborating lab).*

Table 4.1. *Example budget overview.*

Item	Notes	Estimated cost (EUR)
[Item 1]	***[e.g. consumable, software licence]***	***[amount]***
[Item 2]	***[notes]***	***[amount]***
Total		***[total]***

Describe and justify the budget here. If the final cost depends on decisions not yet made (e.g. choice of equipment), state the current best estimate and when it will be confirmed.